English Orbit

PART 4 OF 6 / B1

Intermediate

Explain experiences, solve problems and give reasons.

Read. Listen. Write. Speak. Understand.

An original coursebook companion to the interactive English Orbit course. Four connected lessons combine language explanations with practical activities and guided review.

Included in this part: language focus, vocabulary, reading passages, grammar practice, listening scripts, speaking tasks, writing tasks, a level checkpoint and answer keys.

For independent learners, classrooms and teacher-led study. All teaching content is in English.

Use the course alongside the book

Open English Orbit to hear lesson passages and model sentences. Select this level and the matching lesson.

CEFR labels indicate the intended language focus. This compact companion is not a complete CEFR syllabus or an official proficiency qualification.

Your route through this part

Explain experiences, solve problems and give reasons.

Four lessons, one clear sequence

01 Experiences that change us | Present perfect vs past simple

02 If we make a change | First & second conditionals

03 How things are made | Passive voice

04 A problem worth solving | Reported speech

How to study a lesson

1. Read for the overall meaning. Read again and notice the language focus.
2. Learn the four key words. Make your own example for each word.
3. Complete the reading and grammar practice before checking the answers.
4. Listen without reading first. Write a dictation, then compare it with the script.
5. Speak aloud, record if possible, and reflect on your delivery.
6. Write a response, review it and revise at least one sentence.

> Suggested rhythm: 25-40 minutes in the app, plus 20-30 minutes of book practice per lesson. Take breaks and repeat difficult activities rather than rushing to the next level.

Use a notebook for extended answers. Listening can use the app, a teacher or a study partner. The PDF contains scripts and tasks; it does not contain embedded audio.

For open questions, wording may differ from the sample answers. For speaking and writing, use the review criteria; there is no single correct personal response.

Experiences that change us

LANGUAGE FOCUS / Present perfect vs past simple

01 / Read and notice

I have volunteered at a community garden for two years. I joined in 2024, when a neighbour invited me. Since then, I have learned how to grow vegetables and work in a team. Last Saturday, we organised our first open day. More than fifty visitors came, and several signed up to help.

Language focus

Present perfect: have/has + past participle, for experiences or a period continuing now. Past simple describes a finished time: I joined in 2024. For gives duration; since gives a starting point.

Key words

volunteer - work without pay to help

community - people in a shared place

sign up - register

neighbour - a person living nearby

Read again. Underline one example of the language focus. Explain what it means, then write a similar sentence about yourself.

Understand and practise

Experiences that change us

02 / Reading comprehension

Choose the best answer, then answer the two detail questions in complete sentences.

Which event has a specific finished time?

A. Learning teamwork / B. Volunteering for two years / C. Organising the open day last Saturday

2. How did the writer join the garden?

3. What happened after the open day?

03 / Language practice

Complete each sentence using the word bank. Use each entry once.

Word bank: have volunteered / joined / organised / since / for

1. I _____ here for two years and still do.

2. I _____ in 2024.

3. I have worked here _____ 2024.

4. I have worked here _____ two years.

5. Last Saturday we _____ an open day.

Make it personal: write two new sentences using the same pattern in your notebook. Check word order and verb form.

Listen, speak and write

Experiences that change us

04 / Listening

In the app, open this lesson and select Listening. Play the first sentence without reading. Write what you hear, then replay and check. For longer practice, use the full passage in Reading.

Second listen: choose three key words. Retell the main idea in one or two sentences. The listening script is the passage on the first page of this lesson.

05 / Speaking

> I have volunteered for two years. I joined when a neighbour invited me.

Listen to the model, repeat it twice, then speak for 45-60 seconds about the topic. Include one personal or imaginary example. Record and listen back if possible.

Check: Are the key words clear? Are pauses natural? Did you use the target structure? Repeat once and improve one thing. Transcript matching in the app is not a pronunciation grade.

06 / Writing

Write 100-120 words about something you have learned. Use present perfect for experience and past simple for one event.

Use a notebook if you need more space. Review your response: answer the prompt, use the target language, organise ideas, check verb forms and punctuation, then revise one sentence.

Self-review: One thing I can now do / One thing I will practise again.

If we make a change

LANGUAGE FOCUS / First & second conditionals

01 / Read and notice

Our town has too much traffic. If the council improves bus services, more people will leave their cars at home. However, change may be slow. If I were the mayor, I would create safer cycle lanes too. These ideas require money, but they could make everyday travel easier.

Language focus

First conditional: if + present, will + base verb, for a possible future. Second: if + past, would + base verb, for an imagined situation. If I were is a common formal pattern.

Key words

council - local governing group

mayor - leader of a town or city

cycle lane - a path for bicycles

require - need

Read again. Underline one example of the language focus. Explain what it means, then write a similar sentence about yourself.

Understand and practise

If we make a change

02 / Reading comprehension

Choose the best answer, then answer the two detail questions in complete sentences.

Which idea is presented as an imagined role?

A. The council improving buses / B. The writer being mayor / C. People leaving cars at home

2. What change is proposed in addition to better buses?

3. What practical limitation is acknowledged?

03 / Language practice

Complete each sentence using the word bank. Use each entry once.

Word bank: would create / will leave / had / possible / save

1. If the council improves buses, more people _____ cars at home.

2. If I were mayor, I _____ cycle lanes.

3. If we _____ money, we will buy new books.

4. If I _____ more time, I would volunteer.

5. The first conditional describes a _____ future.

Make it personal: write two new sentences using the same pattern in your notebook. Check word order and verb form.

Listen, speak and write

If we make a change

04 / Listening

In the app, open this lesson and select Listening. Play the first sentence without reading. Write what you hear, then replay and check. For longer practice, use the full passage in Reading.

Second listen: choose three key words. Retell the main idea in one or two sentences. The listening script is the passage on the first page of this lesson.

05 / Speaking

> If the council improves buses, more people will leave their cars at home.

Listen to the model, repeat it twice, then speak for 45-60 seconds about the topic. Include one personal or imaginary example. Record and listen back if possible.

Check: Are the key words clear? Are pauses natural? Did you use the target structure? Repeat once and improve one thing. Transcript matching in the app is not a pronunciation grade.

06 / Writing

Write 100-120 words proposing a change at school or work. Use both a realistic and an imagined conditional.

Use a notebook if you need more space. Review your response: answer the prompt, use the target language, organise ideas, check verb forms and punctuation, then revise one sentence.

Self-review: One thing I can now do / One thing I will practise again.

How things are made

LANGUAGE FOCUS / Passive voice

01 / Read and notice

The notebooks sold in our shop are made from recycled paper. The paper is collected from local offices and sorted by workers. It is then cleaned and pressed into new sheets. Last year, the packaging was redesigned to use less plastic. Customers are given information about the production process.

Language focus

Passive: be + past participle. Present: paper is collected. Past: packaging was redesigned. Use it when the action or result matters more than the doer. Add by when the doer is relevant.

Key words

recycled - processed for use again

sort - put into groups

sheet - a thin flat piece

packaging - material around a product

Read again. Underline one example of the language focus. Explain what it means, then write a similar sentence about yourself.

Understand and practise

How things are made

02 / Reading comprehension

Choose the best answer, then answer the two detail questions in complete sentences.

Why is the passive useful in this text?

A. It focuses on the process / B. It hides the time of every event / C. It makes all actions future

2. How did the packaging change?

3. Where does the recycled paper come from?

03 / Language practice

Complete each sentence using the word bank. Use each entry once.

Word bank: is collected / are pressed / is given / was redesigned / is collected

1. The paper _____ every week.

2. Last year the packaging _____.

3. The sheets _____ into shape.

4. Information _____ to customers.

5. Workers collect paper. Passive: Paper _____ by workers.

Make it personal: write two new sentences using the same pattern in your notebook. Check word order and verb form.

Listen, speak and write

How things are made

04 / Listening

In the app, open this lesson and select Listening. Play the first sentence without reading. Write what you hear, then replay and check. For longer practice, use the full passage in Reading.

Second listen: choose three key words. Retell the main idea in one or two sentences. The listening script is the passage on the first page of this lesson.

05 / Speaking

> The paper is collected, cleaned and pressed into new sheets.

Listen to the model, repeat it twice, then speak for 45-60 seconds about the topic. Include one personal or imaginary example. Record and listen back if possible.

Check: Are the key words clear? Are pauses natural? Did you use the target structure? Repeat once and improve one thing. Transcript matching in the app is not a pronunciation grade.

06 / Writing

Explain a familiar process in 100-120 words. Include three passive structures and sequence words.

Use a notebook if you need more space. Review your response: answer the prompt, use the target language, organise ideas, check verb forms and punctuation, then revise one sentence.

Self-review: One thing I can now do / One thing I will practise again.

A problem worth solving

LANGUAGE FOCUS / Reported speech

01 / Read and notice

During the meeting, Lena said that the team needed more time. Omar explained that two files were missing. The manager asked whether they could finish by Friday. Lena replied that they would send a revised schedule that afternoon. Everyone agreed to share updates daily until the work was complete.

Language focus

Reported speech conveys a message without quoting it. After a past reporting verb, tenses often shift: need to needed; will to would. Reported yes/no questions use if or whether, with statement word order.

Key words

revised - changed or updated

schedule - a plan with times

reply - answer

daily - every day

Read again. Underline one example of the language focus. Explain what it means, then write a similar sentence about yourself.

Understand and practise

A problem worth solving

02 / Reading comprehension

Choose the best answer, then answer the two detail questions in complete sentences.

What did Lena promise?

A. To finish immediately / B. To send a revised schedule / C. To cancel the meeting

2. Why did the team need a revised schedule?

3. How often will they share updates?

03 / Language practice

Complete each sentence using the word bank. Use each entry once.

Word bank: statement / whether / would send / needed / were

1. Lena said the team _____ more time.

2. Omar explained that files _____ missing.

3. They said they _____ a schedule.

4. The manager asked _____ they could finish.

5. Reported questions use _____ word order.

Make it personal: write two new sentences using the same pattern in your notebook. Check word order and verb form.

Listen, speak and write

A problem worth solving

04 / Listening

In the app, open this lesson and select Listening. Play the first sentence without reading. Write what you hear, then replay and check. For longer practice, use the full passage in Reading.

Second listen: choose three key words. Retell the main idea in one or two sentences. The listening script is the passage on the first page of this lesson.

05 / Speaking

> Lena said that the team needed more time.

Listen to the model, repeat it twice, then speak for 45-60 seconds about the topic. Include one personal or imaginary example. Record and listen back if possible.

Check: Are the key words clear? Are pauses natural? Did you use the target structure? Repeat once and improve one thing. Transcript matching in the app is not a pronunciation grade.

06 / Writing

Write a 100-120 word summary of an imaginary meeting. Report two statements and one question.

Use a notebook if you need more space. Review your response: answer the prompt, use the target language, organise ideas, check verb forms and punctuation, then revise one sentence.

Self-review: One thing I can now do / One thing I will practise again.

Level checkpoint / 1 of 2

Eight questions across meaning and language. Refer to the lesson passages for reading questions.

Choose one answer per question. Pass this practice check with at least 6 out of 8 correct. It is not an official placement or certification test.

01. Which event has a specific finished time?

A. Learning teamwork

B. Volunteering for two years

C. Organising the open day last Saturday

Reading reference: Lesson 1, Experiences that change us

02. Choose the sentence with a finished past time.

A. I have joined yesterday.

B. I joined yesterday.

C. I joining yesterday.

Language focus review

03. Which idea is presented as an imagined role?

A. The council improving buses

B. The writer being mayor

C. People leaving cars at home

Reading reference: Lesson 2, If we make a change

04. Complete: If I were mayor, I ___ improve cycle lanes.

A. would

B. will

C. am

Language focus review

Level checkpoint / 2 of 2

Eight questions across meaning and language. Refer to the lesson passages for reading questions.

Choose one answer per question. Pass this practice check with at least 6 out of 8 correct. It is not an official placement or certification test.

05. Why is the passive useful in this text?

A. It focuses on the process

B. It hides the time of every event

C. It makes all actions future

Reading reference: Lesson 3, How things are made

06. Choose the passive sentence.

A. Workers collect paper.

B. Paper collects workers.

C. Paper is collected by workers.

Language focus review

07. What did Lena promise?

A. To finish immediately

B. To send a revised schedule

C. To cancel the meeting

Reading reference: Lesson 4, A problem worth solving

08. Report: "We will send a schedule."

A. They said they will sent a schedule.

B. They said they would send a schedule.

C. They said would they send a schedule.

Language focus review

Answer key / 1 of 2

Check after trying. Alternative wording is acceptable in open answers.

Lesson 1 / Experiences that change us

Reading 1: C. Organising the open day last Saturday. "Last Saturday" marks a finished past time, so the text uses the past simple.

Reading 2: A neighbour invited the writer.

Reading 3: Several visitors signed up to help.

Language practice: 1. have volunteered; 2. joined; 3. since; 4. for; 5. organised

Dictation: I have volunteered at a community garden for two years.

Lesson 2 / If we make a change

Reading 1: B. The writer being mayor. "If I were the mayor" imagines a role the writer does not currently have.

Reading 2: Safer cycle lanes.

Reading 3: The ideas require money and change may be slow.

Language practice: 1. will leave; 2. would create; 3. save; 4. had; 5. possible

Dictation: Our town has too much traffic.

Checkpoint answers

1. C: "Last Saturday" marks a finished past time, so the text uses the past simple.
2. B: Yesterday requires the past simple here.

3. B: "If I were the mayor" imagines a role the writer does not currently have.
4. A: Imagined situations use would in the result clause.

Answer key / 2 of 2

Check after trying. Alternative wording is acceptable in open answers.

Lesson 3 / How things are made

Reading 1: A. It focuses on the process. The main topic is how notebooks are produced, not the identities of individual workers.

Reading 2: It was redesigned to use less plastic.

Reading 3: Local offices.

Language practice: 1. is collected; 2. was redesigned; 3. are pressed; 4. is given; 5. is collected

Dictation: The notebooks sold in our shop are made from recycled paper.

Lesson 4 / A problem worth solving

Reading 1: B. To send a revised schedule. Lena replied that they would send a revised schedule that afternoon.

Reading 2: They needed more time and two files were missing.

Reading 3: Daily until the work is complete.

Language practice: 1. needed; 2. were; 3. would send; 4. whether; 5. statement

Dictation: During the meeting, Lena said that the team needed more time.

Checkpoint answers

5. A: The main topic is how notebooks are produced, not the identities of individual workers.
6. C: Passive uses be + past participle.

7. B: Lena replied that they would send a revised schedule that afternoon.
8. B: Will typically shifts to would after a past reporting verb.

Review and continue

Use evidence of practice, not just a score.

Writing review

There is no single correct response to a personal writing prompt. Use this four-part review and ask a teacher or partner for feedback when possible.

Task - My response answers the prompt and gives relevant examples.

Language - I attempted the target structure and checked verb forms and word order.

Organisation - Ideas follow a clear order. At higher levels, claims have support and qualifications.

Revision - I improved one sentence after rereading or receiving feedback.

Speaking review

Focus on intelligibility, appropriate vocabulary, complete ideas and natural pauses. At Starter, short clear phrases are enough. At Advanced, support a position, respond to alternatives and choose an appropriate register.

After your checkpoint

6-8 correct: continue if the productive tasks also feel manageable.
0-5 correct: revisit the language explanations and try new examples before retaking the check.

A strong multiple-choice score alone does not demonstrate writing or speaking proficiency. Keep a portfolio of drafts and recordings.

Next step: Upper-intermediate - Discuss ideas, weigh evidence and express nuanced opinions.